

I was also let down a bit while using the Noise ALT Watch 1 during the night. I usually sleep with smartwatches on purpose, since it's the only real way to test sleep tracking and see how comfortable a device actually is over long hours. I've done this with quite a few other watches without any issues, but the ALT Watch 1 just didn't sit right on my wrist at night. A few times, I genuinely felt like taking it off before bed instead of just leaving it on.

HEALTH TRACKING

Health tracking is probably the most important thing on any smartwatch these days, especially with brands pouring so much money into getting this right. The good news is that the ALT Watch 1 holds up well here. I tested it while walking, doing light jogging, and during my regular workouts, and the results were mostly the same each time.

The heart rate readings were quite accurate throughout most of the test period, and my SpO₂ measurements were also in line with my expectations. Sleep tracking proved to be accurate at depicting my sleep cycle, while the number of steps recorded was somewhat closer to the real thing.

Is the data lab-grade accurate? No. Would I trust it on a daily basis for fitness tracking purposes? Yes, certainly. In my opinion, the watch should be considered a tool for fitness and everyday monitoring, rather than one that provides absolutely accurate information. The readings may not always be precise, yet they are still accurate enough to follow your progress in terms of fitness level.

SOFTWARE EXPERIENCE

One of the most pleasant surprises during my time with the Noise ALT Watch 1 was the software experience. Connecting the watch via the NoiseFit application has been both fast and easy. I tried pairing it with an Android at first, and the process was lightning fast. I also tried connecting it to an iPhone and had the same nice experience.

Many people often forget about cross-device compatibility, which can be very useful in case someone switches their devices or simply owns several phones. The application itself is easy to use and offers fast access to all kinds of data and health information. I didn't experience any problems during my testing phase, and the connection was steady all the time.

PERFORMANCE

The performance of a smartwatch is determined by its ability to perform common tasks, notifications being one of them. Luckily for us, ALT Watch 1 has done great here.

The notifications came promptly and without delay, regardless of whether the battery was low or if the device had entered the power-saving mode. Such stability made this watch a practical companion all throughout the day, as I didn't feel the urge to pull out my phone to check on the notifications coming in.

Bluetooth calls have been mostly positive, with decent voice clarity and no issues reported by callers hearing me. On my end, the sound quality was good at normal volume levels. However, I did notice some problems when the volume was turned up to the maximum. At full volume, the caller's voice began to crackle and buzz, as though it was being over-amplified.

AI FEATURES

Noise marketed the ALT Watch 1 as an AI-focused smartwatch. But honestly, it didn't live up to the hype for me. The morning briefs did show basic stuff like weather and temperature, but that's about it, as nothing here felt unique or particularly useful.

The AI watch faces and the AI companion app left me disappointed. I won't go as far as calling these features completely useless, but they're nowhere near the level Noise made them out to be. What I can say is they are eye-catching.

Long story short, the marketing made them seem much more impressive than they actually are, and this

creates a noticeable gap between what is promised and what you get in real use. In my view, it is better to see these AI features as small extras rather than the main reason to buy the smartwatch. If you do that, you will probably have a better overall experience.

CUSTOMISATION

Another area where I felt that Noise could have done a better job with the ALT Watch 1 is the customisation part of the watch faces. Though the available watch faces look fine, and there is a decent selection to choose from, I felt it lagging when compared with the other watches in the same price bracket.

One of the features I missed was the ability to customise colours on certain static watch faces. While it may sound like a minor detail, these small personalisation options make a smartwatch feel more personal and unique.

SHOULD YOU BUY IT?

The Noise ALT Watch 1 is a smartwatch that gets many fundamentals right while simultaneously reminding you that it is still a first-generation product.

I would not call the Noise ALT Watch 1 a bad smartwatch. If you are looking for a smartwatch with a bright display, dependable notifications, good software support, and health tracking that is accurate enough, the ALT Watch 1 makes a compelling case for itself, especially at a price point of Rs 5,999.

—**Bhaskar Sharma**

SPECIFICATIONS

Display: 1.32" 466x466 AMOLED | Brightness: 1000 nits | Health Tracking: Heart Rate, HRV, Sleep, Stress, SpO₂, Cycle Tracking | Sports Mode: 100+ | Water resistance: 1 ATM | Battery: 14 days | Weight: 32 g | Bluetooth Calling: Yes | Frame: Anodised Aluminium

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